

**THE PLAN**

Getting customers

How you find people who will pay you, what you say to them, and what you publish while you do it.

Status labels apply throughout: KNOWN, VERIFIED, ASSUMPTION, ESTIMATE, TO VALIDATE, PROPOSED. Nothing in this document claims traction, approvals, partners or revenue that do not exist. Governing file: FACTS_BASE.

PREPARED FOR

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How you find people who will pay you, what you say to them, and what you publish while you do it.

In one minute

- Your first money comes from advisory work you deliver yourself, not from the app.
- Sell to UK health-tech founders and investors first. They decide in weeks, not months.
- Every week: 40 new contacts, 20 conversations, 5 calls, 2 proposals.
- Never claim a client, an approval or a pilot you do not have.
- Publish three posts a week, one report and one webinar in 90 days.

What to do

Action	Who	By when
Build the 150-name contact list and set up the CRM	You	Fri 18 Sept 2026
Send the first 40 messages, using the templates below	You	Fri 18 Sept 2026
Hold the first 5 discovery calls and send 2 proposals	You	Sun 27 Sept 2026
Full weekly rate every week from here on	You	From Mon 28 Sept 2026
Sign the first client; sign the third	You	Tue 13 Oct and Fri 11 Dec 2026

Where the first clients come from

Spend at least 60% of your selling time on the first two groups. They pay fastest.

Who	What they buy	Typical deal (ESTIMATE, our best guess)	How long they take
UK digital-health start-ups	Help getting NHS-ready, investor-ready, and to market	£2.5k to £5k a month, or £7.5k to £15k for a sprint	2 to 6 weeks
UK health-tech investors and accelerators	Workshops for their companies, help checking a deal	£5k to £20k per programme	4 to 8 weeks
NHS-adjacent bodies and charities	Research, procurement readiness, training	£5k to £25k a project	8 to 16 weeks
African health ministries, NGOs and donors	Strategy, programme design, pilot scoping	£10k to £50k a study	3 to 9 months

Weekly targets by channel:

Channel	What you do each week	What good looks like
LinkedIn messages	40 connection requests, 20 messages	30% accept, 15% reply
LinkedIn posts	3 posts, 20 real comments on other people's posts	5 inbound conversations a month
Warm introductions	5 asks	2 introductions
Cold email	25 new contacts, to public business addresses only	8% reply

Channel	What you do each week	What good looks like
Events	1 UK health-tech event a fortnight	10 conversations, 3 follow-up meetings
Referrals	Ask "who else should I speak to?" on every call	2 customer referrals a month
Partners	2 new conversations with accelerators or networks	1 referral agreement a quarter

The floor, every week from week three: **40 new contacts, 20 conversations, 5 discovery calls, 2 proposals.**

The conversation

A discovery call is a first 30-minute call to find out what someone needs. Keep to this shape.

Minutes	What you do
0 to 3	Thank them, agree the agenda, ask permission to ask questions
3 to 8	Their role, their organisation, what made them take the call
8 to 18	The problem: what happens today, what they have tried, what it costs them
18 to 23	The decision: budget, who signs, timing, what success looks like
23 to 27	Say back what you heard; describe one or two ways you could help. No hard sell
27 to 30	Agree one specific next step and a date

The eight questions worth asking:

1. What made you take this call now?
2. How is this handled today, and what have you already tried?
3. What does success look like for you in six months?
4. What is this costing you now, in time, money or risk?
5. Who signs off on money like this, and is there a budget already?
6. What is setting the timing: a board meeting, a funding round, a deadline?
7. What would make this a no?
8. If we started on a set date, what would the first two weeks need to deliver?

Write the answers into the CRM the same day, under: problem, cost, who decides, budget, timing, what success means, next step.

Two emails and one message

Email 1 — first contact with a founder

Subject: [Company]'s NHS route — one question Hi [First name], I read your [post about X]. One question: have you mapped the DTAC and clinical-safety evidence you will need before an NHS pilot conversation, or is that still ahead of you? I am Kelvin, founder of Vytalix, a UK health-technology advisory group. We are early ourselves. We are building MaternaLink, a maternal care-coordination platform, in development, so I have been living these questions first-hand. If it helps, I can share the one-page checklist I use. Worth 20 minutes next week? Kelvin Williams, Vytalix

Email 2 — the same day as a call

Subject: Notes and next steps from today [First name], thank you for your time today. What I heard: (1) [the problem], (2) [what it costs you], (3) [your deadline]. You would call it a success if [their words]. Next step: I will send a short proposal with two options by [date], and we decide by [date]. If I have misread anything, tell me now and I will correct it.

LinkedIn message, after they accept your request

Thanks for connecting, [Name]. One question: what is the hardest part of [their challenge] at [Organisation] right now? I am asking founders and leaders this as I shape Vytalix's advisory work, and I am glad to share back what I am hearing.

The ten objections and what to say

They say	You say
"You are too new, you have no track record."	"True, and I will not pretend otherwise. What I bring is [your real experience]. The work is fixed-scope and paid on delivery, and the first piece is small. If it does not land, you stop."
"Too expensive."	"Compared with what? If it is in-house time, let us cost that. If it is budget, Option A is scoped to [price] and the rest can wait."
"No budget this quarter."	"Understood. Would a smaller piece at [price] that builds your business case for next quarter help? Otherwise let us put a date in for [month]."
"We can do this ourselves."	"You can. The question is speed. We would compress weeks of learning. If you would rather build the skill in-house, the workshop version hands the method to your team."
"Send me some information."	"Happy to. So I send the right thing: is the priority [A] or [B]? I will send a one-pager and suggest 15 minutes to talk it through."
"We are talking to a bigger firm."	"Good, and compare us on who actually does the work, on speed and on price. I deliver it myself, and I will put that in writing."
"Is MaternaLink live? Can we see it?"	"MaternaLink is in development. There is an early prototype and I will show it as a concept, not a product. Today is about the advisory work, which does not depend on it."
"Are you NHS-approved or CE-marked?"	"No, and we do not claim to be. Advisory work does not need it. Any software going into the NHS would go through DTAC and clinical safety first, which is the path we help clients plan."
"It is not the right time."	"When would be? What changes by then? If [trigger] happens sooner, would you want to move faster?"
"Can you do it for free, or for equity?"	"I will give you a free 30 minutes. Paid work stays paid, because that is how I stay independent. Equity only alongside cash, and only where it fits."

What you put out publicly

Every dated item is a row in `/assets/CONTENT_CALENDAR.csv`. That file is the schedule; this table is the shape.

Month	What you publish	What you are aiming for
Month 1, 14 Sept to 13 Oct	Rewritten LinkedIn profile with "pre-seed" said out loud. 12 posts. Company page once the name is cleared. Website live with the legal pages and honest prices marked "from". First article. Newsletter issue 1.	500 relevant followers, 300 website visits, 50 subscribers

Month	What you publish	What you are aiming for
Month 2, 14 Oct to 12 Nov	12 posts. Second article. Newsletter issues 2 and 3. Twenty interviews for the research report. Webinar announced. Report drafted and designed.	900 followers, 200 subscribers, 60 webinar registrations, 3 inbound conversations
Month 3, 13 Nov to 12 Dec	Webinar on Tue 17 Nov, 12:30 to 13:15. Research report "The State of Digital Maternal Care Coordination: UK and Nigeria, 2026" published Fri 20 Nov, with a download form. Press pitch to three outlets. Third article. 12 posts. Newsletter issues 4 and 5.	1,500 followers, 300 subscribers, 150 downloads in 14 days, 40 webinar attendees, 1 press mention

The report is 20 to 28 pages, built on 20 interviews and a survey, with the limits of the method stated in it. No patient data is used.

How to price a proposal, and when to walk away

Keep the proposal to about four pages: what you understood, what success means, what you will do, when, the price, what you assume, and a signature line. Offer two or three options and put a date on which the price expires.

Rule	The number
Day rate	£900, range £800 to £1,200 (ESTIMATE)
Monthly retainer	£2,500 to £5,000
Fixed sprint	£7,500 to £25,000
Never go below	£650 a day equivalent
Discount	15% at most, and only for prepayment or volume. Never cut price without cutting scope or getting something back, such as a reference
Payment	Projects 50% up front. Retainers monthly in advance
Free work	One free 30-minute session per prospect. No free workshops
MaternaLink pilots	Never free. Minimum £10,000 (ESTIMATE), and only with data-protection and safety conditions agreed first
Nigerian government work	Quote in pounds or dollars. At least 30% paid before you start. No work before that payment arrives

Walk away when any of these is true: they ask you to go below the floor; they want free work or equity with no cash; after two calls nobody will name who signs; they want you to say something untrue, such as NHS-approved or clinically proven; the scope keeps growing while the price stays still.

What to measure each week

Six numbers, in the Friday review. Nothing else.

Number	Target
New contacts added	40
Real conversations held	20
Discovery calls held	5

Number	Target
Proposals sent	2
Posts published	3
Inbound enquiries (they came to you)	3 by week 4, 15 by week 13

Words explained

Word	What it means
CRM	The software that holds your contacts, your deals and what stage each one is at
Discovery call	A first 30-minute call to find out what someone needs, before any pitch
Retainer	A fixed monthly fee for an agreed amount of your time
Sprint	A fixed piece of work with a fixed price and an end date
DTAC	The NHS checklist a digital product must pass before a hospital can buy it
Inbound	Someone who contacts you first, rather than you contacting them
Mobilisation payment	Money paid up front so you can start work, common in government contracts